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Annotated Bibliography

The following bibliography compiles all sources cited across the various deliverables produced for this project. Delaware Education Standards Review, Comparative State Analysis, Youth Civic Engagement Best Practices Memo, Strategic Nonviolence Research Brief, School and Community Partnership Toolkit, Workshop Implementation Framework, and Grant Narrative Language.

Works Cited

Academy for Social Civics. Delaware. Academy 4 Social Civics, 13 Oct. 2022, new.academy4sc.org/2022/10/13/delaware/.

This source documents Delaware's K-12 civics standards structure, analyzing four anchor standards: Government, Politics, Citizenship, and Participation, and identifying grade-level distribution patterns. The analysis reveals that participatory learning mandates concentrate in elementary and ninth-grade bands while largely disappearing in grades 10-12, a gap that directly informed the Delaware framework's statewide policy front by establishing the evidentiary case for extending and deepening participatory civic instruction through all secondary grades.

Carnegie Corporation of New York and CivicPulse. Polarization in America: Survey of Local Government, Survey III. CivicPulse, 2026, www.carnegie.org/publications/polarization-in-america-survey-of-local-government-survey-iii/.

This survey of 1,399 local government officials, conducted by CivicPulse in fall 2025, documents how political polarization shapes governing capacity at the municipal, county, and school board levels across the United States. Its findings on the corrosive effects of polarization on public trust and cross-sector collaboration supported the community-rooted power building front of the Delaware framework by grounding the rationale for nonpartisan, relationship-centered civic education as a structural counterweight to democratic dysfunction at the local level.

Center for Civic Education. C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards. Center for Civic Education, 2013, www.civiced.org.

The C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards establishes a four-dimensional instructional architecture centered on civic inquiry, disciplinary knowledge, and application of learning to real-world issues. It served as the primary national standards

reference for Delaware's framework design, providing the pedagogical rationale for integrating inquiry-based practice, deliberation, and civic action across all grade levels and LEA implementation contexts.

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC). "Promoting School Connectedness Through Restorative Practices." CDC, 2024, [cdc.gov/youth-behavior/school-connectedness/restorative-practices.html](https://www.cdc.gov/youth-behavior/school-connectedness/restorative-practices.html).

This CDC resource defines restorative practices as evidence-informed strategies that build school community through proactive relationship-building and responsive conflict resolution, including affective language, restorative circles, and reentry processes. Its evidence base for restorative practices as tools for school connectedness and student agency underpinned the school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front, supporting the Delaware framework's integration of circle processes and community-of-accountability structures within K-12 settings.

Center for Information and Research on Civic Learning and Engagement (CIRCLE). "25 Things We Learned About Young Voters in 2025." Tufts University, 27 Jan. 2026, circle.tufts.edu/latest-research/25-things-we-learned-about-young-voters-2025.

This CIRCLE report compiles 25 findings on youth voting and civic engagement patterns from the 2024 and 2025 election cycles, documenting persistent turnout disparities by race, gender, geography, and socioeconomic status, including a 9-point gender gap and significant decline among Latino youth. The data on differential civic participation rates and the correlation between school-based civic learning and youth voter readiness provided longitudinal benchmarks for the statewide policy and LEA implementation front, particularly for designing equity-targeted interventions in underserved Delaware districts.

"Equitable K-12 Civic Learning." Tufts University, 2024, circle.tufts.edu/our-research/equitable-k12-civic-learning.

This CIRCLE research hub examines the conditions under which K-12 civic learning produces equitable outcomes, focusing on how race, income, and institutional structures shape students' access to high-quality civic learning experiences. It grounded the Delaware framework's equity commitments across all four strategic fronts by establishing that structural disparities in civic opportunity require deliberate policy interventions at both the state and LEA levels, not solely classroom-level adjustments.

"Growing Voters Year-Round: Program Examples to Build Youth Engagement." Tufts University, 7 Sept. 2023, circle.tufts.edu/latest-research/growing-voters-year-round-program-examples-build-youth-engagement.

This report catalogs program models through which schools, local governments, and community organizations cultivate year-round youth civic and electoral engagement beyond election cycles, with examples spanning voter registration drives, civic simulations, and community action projects. The program model inventory informed the school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by supplying concrete, replicable frameworks for integrating sustained youth engagement into Delaware's K-12 civic learning calendar.

"The State of Civic Education in Massachusetts." Tufts University,
circle.tufts.edu/latest-research/state-civic-education-massachusetts.

This CIRCLE analysis of Massachusetts examines how a state that enacted comprehensive civics legislation in 2018 has implemented and assessed civic education across its districts, detailing outcomes from the Civics Project Trust Fund and identifying implementation gaps that persist despite legislative mandate. It functioned as a primary comparative state model for the Delaware framework's statewide policy front, demonstrating both the gains achievable through sustained public investment and the limitations of policy without robust professional development and funding equity.

"Youth Are Taking Civic Action, But Need Opportunities and Support to Overcome Socioeconomic Barriers." Tufts University, 30 Sept. 2025,
circle.tufts.edu/latest-research/youth-are-taking-civic-action-need-opportunities-and-support-overcome-socioeconomic.

This CIRCLE report finds that youth across income levels are already engaged in civic action through advocacy, protest, and community organizing, but that access to structured civic opportunities remains uneven, with lower-income youth facing greater structural barriers to participation. The findings substantiated the community-rooted power building front's core argument that civic frameworks must actively reduce structural access barriers rather than assuming voluntarism will distribute civic opportunity equitably.

Cohen, Alison K., et al. "Action Civics for Promoting Civic Development: Main Effects of Program Participation and Differences by Project Characteristics." PubMed Central, 2017, [pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5654523/](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5654523/).

This peer-reviewed study uses quantitative and qualitative data from 617 middle and high school students in 55 Generation Citizen classrooms to test the effects of action civics on civic commitment, civic self-efficacy, and civic knowledge. It found significant effects on civic self-efficacy and marginal effects on future civic commitment, providing the strongest available experimental evidence for the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front's decision to center action civics as a core pedagogical model.

"The I-ACTED Study (Investigating Action Civics Training Through an Experimental Design): A Cluster Randomized Controlled Trial of a School-Based Action Civics Education Intervention on Adolescent Wellbeing." BMC Public Health, vol. 25, 16 Oct. 2025, article 3513, doi.org/10.1186/s12889-025-24838-y.

This registered cluster randomized controlled trial, funded by the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation, tests whether action civics curricular materials improve civic readiness and wellbeing outcomes among approximately 1,500 middle and high school students, measuring community connection, mental health, and civic participation. As one of the first RCTs in civic education research, it anchored the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front's evidence standard, establishing a rigorous methodological benchmark for assessing the causal effects of action civics on adolescent development.

Connected Learning Alliance. "New Report Reviews Impact of Asset and Action-Based Approaches to Civic Learning for Minoritized Youth." 28 June 2022, clalliance.org/blog/new-report-reviews-impact-of-asset-and-action-based-approaches-to-civic-learning-for-minoritized-youth/.

This Connected Learning Alliance summary reviews a research report examining how asset-based and action-oriented approaches to civic learning support sociopolitical development, critical consciousness, and a range of educational outcomes among youth from marginalized communities. It advanced the community-rooted power building front of the Delaware framework by building the evidentiary case that effective civic education for youth of color must center lived experience, ethnic identity, and relational assets rather than applying a deficit model of civic preparation.

Connecticut Center for Nonviolence (CTCN). Kingian Nonviolence Trainings. Connecticut Center for Nonviolence, 2025, ctnonviolence.org/programs/kingian-nonviolence-trainings/.

The Connecticut Center for Nonviolence offers Kingian Nonviolence training programs rooted in the philosophy and methodology of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., providing structured curricula for communities, schools, and organizations to apply Six Principles and Six Steps of Nonviolence to conflict transformation. This program model served as a replication reference for the Delaware framework's strategic nonviolence and leadership development front, demonstrating how Kingian Nonviolence can be institutionalized within a state-based training infrastructure.

Council of State Governments. Civics Education: Policy Brief. The Council of State Governments, May 2022, web.csg.org/csghealthystates/wp-content/uploads/sites/23/2022/05/Healthy-States-National-Task-Force-Policy-Brief-Civics-Education.pdf.

This CSG Healthy States National Task Force policy brief outlines state legislative options for strengthening civics education, including increasing course requirements, reforming standards and curriculum, and enhancing accountability mechanisms, drawing on research showing civics instruction improves students' capacity for political reasoning. It contributed to the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by providing a menu of legislative levers and an analytical framework for evaluating existing policy gaps against proven state practices.

Cyril, Khadijah Nelly. The Kingian Nonviolence Conflict Reconciliation Training Program: Outcomes for High School Students' Cultural, Social, and Emotional Learning. Open Access Dissertations, University of Rhode Island, 2020, digitalcommons.uri.edu/oa_diss/1174/.

This doctoral dissertation examines outcomes of the Kingian Nonviolence Conflict Reconciliation program with high school students, finding that participation supported gains in self-awareness, social-emotional learning, and awareness of the root causes of violence. It provided the foundational program-outcomes evidence for the Delaware framework's strategic nonviolence and leadership development front, demonstrating that Kingian Nonviolence training produces measurable cultural, social, and emotional learning gains in adolescent populations.

Delaware Center for Civic Education. University of Delaware Biden School, udel.edu/academics/colleges/biden-school/research-public-service/ipa/public-service/dcce/.

The Delaware Center for Civic Education, housed at the University of Delaware's Biden School, coordinates professional development, standards-aligned resources, and student programs including Project Citizen, We the People, and the Governor's Civics Awards, serving as the state's primary institutional infrastructure for educator capacity-building in civics. It contributed directly to the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front as the existing in-state partner organization whose programming the framework was designed to complement, deepen, and scale.

Delaware Department of Education. "Standards and Assessments." education.delaware.gov/educators/academic-support/standards-and-assessments/.

Delaware's Department of Education Standards and Assessments page documents the state's formal academic content standards across subject areas, establishing the regulatory architecture within which civics and social studies instruction must operate at the LEA level. It served as the baseline policy reference for the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front, confirming the absence of statewide civics assessment requirements and identifying the regulatory space available for framework-aligned LEA implementation guidance.

Education Commission of the States. State Civic Education Policy: Framework and Gap Analysis Tool. ECS, 2022, ecs.org.

The Education Commission of the States' civic education policy framework provides a comprehensive gap analysis tool that allows state leaders to assess their current policies against a research-aligned set of civic education components including standards, assessments, professional development, and civic action requirements. It structured the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by providing the analytical scaffolding for mapping Delaware's existing policy landscape and identifying specific gaps where new policy or programming was needed.

García-González, Ana, et al. "Restorative Practices in Reducing School Violence: A Systematic Review of Positive Impacts on Emotional Wellbeing." *Frontiers in Education*, Feb. 2025, doi.org/10.3389/feduc.2025.1520137.

This systematic review synthesizes research on restorative practices across school settings, finding consistent evidence that implementation reduces school violence and improves students' emotional wellbeing through enhanced belonging, peer relationships, and community accountability. It contributed to the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by providing a peer-reviewed evidence base for embedding restorative practices as both a disciplinary alternative and a civic formation tool within K-12 environments.

Gathering for Justice, The. Programs. The Gathering for Justice, 2020, www.gatheringforjustice.org/programs.

The Gathering for Justice operates youth organizing programs, including Youth Organizers United, Justice University, and Justice League NYC/CA that build leadership capacity among young people through political education, community mobilization, and direct action organizing. Its programming served as a model reference for the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building front, demonstrating how youth-led organizing structures can create the civic agency and relational power necessary for sustained community change.

Generation Citizen. Action Civics in School Districts: District Report. Generation Citizen, 2017, cms.generationcitizen.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/GC-District-Report-170721_final.pdf.

This Generation Citizen district report examines how school districts across the United States have integrated action civics programming, documenting implementation models, partnerships, and outcomes including school retention improvements and enhanced student voice. It informed the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by providing practical guidance for district-level adoption of action

civics, illustrating how LEA-level administrative buy-in and programmatic alignment are prerequisites for scaling school-based civic practice.

Gingold, Jessica. "Building an Evidence-Based Practice of Action Civics: The Current State of Assessments and Recommendations for the Future." CIRCLE Working Paper No. 78, Center for Information and Research on Civic Learning and Engagement, Aug. 2013, circle.tufts.edu/latest-research/building-case-action-civics.

This CIRCLE working paper surveys the landscape of action civics organizations and their evaluation tools, identifies a common six-outcome theory of change spanning civic knowledge, skills, commitment, self-efficacy, and agency, and offers six recommendations for building a shared assessment infrastructure across the field. It established the foundational evaluation framework for the Delaware project's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front, providing the theoretical scaffolding for measuring whether action civics programming produces the civic outcomes the framework claims.

Institute for Local Government. "Governments Engaging Youth Toolkit." ca-ilg.org/governments-engaging-youth-toolkit.

The Institute for Local Government's Governments Engaging Youth Toolkit provides a framework and case models for building school-municipal partnerships that connect classroom civic learning with work-based experiences, career exploration in local government, and structured youth civic participation. It contributed to the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front as a replicable model for formalizing the local government and school district partnerships that the framework recommends as delivery vehicles for civic learning.

Kahne, Joseph, and Ellen Middaugh. "Democracy for Some: The Civic Opportunity Gap in High School." CIRCLE Working Paper No. 59, Center for Information and Research on Civic Learning and Engagement, 2008, www.civicsurvey.org/publications/democracy-for-some-civic-opportunity-gap.

This landmark CIRCLE study finds that a student's race, academic track, and school's socioeconomic status determine access to the civic learning opportunities most associated with political participation, with white, college-bound, and higher-SES students receiving significantly more civic engagement opportunities than their peers. Its documentation of a structural civic opportunity gap across the K-12 pipeline was foundational to the Delaware framework's equity rationale across all four strategic fronts, establishing that civic disparities are not individual but systemic.

Kawashima-Ginsberg, Kei, and Alberto Medina. "How Educators and Policymakers Can Prepare Young People to Engage in the 2024 Election." Brookings Institution, 22 Aug. 2024,

[brookings.edu/articles/how-educators-and-policymakers-can-prepare-young-people-to-engage-in-the-2024-election/](https://www.brookings.edu/articles/how-educators-and-policymakers-can-prepare-young-people-to-engage-in-the-2024-election/).

This Brookings Institution article synthesizes research and policy recommendations for how educators and policymakers can integrate civic and electoral preparation into K-12 settings ahead of the 2024 election, emphasizing the role of nonpartisan civic education in building students' capacity to engage regardless of political context. It informed the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by providing a policy-practitioner bridge document that translates research findings on youth readiness into actionable school and district-level recommendations.

LaFayette, Bernard, Jr., and David Jehnsen. Kingian Nonviolence Leaders Manual. 1995. Kingian Nonviolence Conflict Reconciliation Program.

This foundational curriculum manual, authored by Dr. Bernard LaFayette Jr. and David Jehnsen, codifies the core theoretical framework of Kingian Nonviolence including the Six Principles of Nonviolence and the Six Steps of Nonviolent Campaigns, providing the primary instructional content for all Kingian Nonviolence training programs. It served as the central pedagogical source text for the Delaware framework's strategic nonviolence and leadership development front, supplying the content backbone for workshop curricula and facilitator training.

League of Women Voters of Delaware. Delaware Civics Education Proclamation by Governor Meyer. League of Women Voters of Delaware, 14 Mar. 2026, my.lwv.org/delaware/article/delaware-civics-education-proclamation-governor-meyer.

This League of Women Voters of Delaware article documents Governor Matt Meyer's March 2026 proclamation recognizing the importance of civic education in Delaware, signaling executive-level political will for statewide civic education reform. It established the current political context for the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front, demonstrating that the framework was developed at a moment of aligned gubernatorial support that creates a policy window for sustained civic education investment.

Martínez-García, Marta, et al. "Interventions to Promote Civic Engagement Among Youth and Its Outcomes on Mental Health: A Scoping Review." *Children*, vol. 12, no. 6, 22 May 2025, doi.org/10.3390/children12060665.

This scoping review examines interventions designed to promote civic engagement among youth and analyzes their documented effects on mental health outcomes, finding that structured civic engagement opportunities are associated with improved wellbeing, reduced anxiety, and greater sense of purpose. It contributed to the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building and school-based partnerships fronts by providing evidence that civic engagement is not only a democratic outcome but a health-protective

factor, strengthening the rationale for embedding civic practice into school-based wellness and student support frameworks.

Massachusetts Council for the Social Studies. "Increase Investment in Civic Education, Don't Decrease It." Oct. 2023, masscouncil.org/social-studies-in-massachusetts/.

This Massachusetts Council for the Social Studies statement documents the legislative and budget battles around the state's Civics Project Trust Fund, detailing both the substantial gains achieved since the 2018 civics law and the ongoing political threat to sustained funding. It contributed to the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by providing a cautionary case study illustrating how civic education gains can be undermined by executive veto or legislative inaction even after successful policy enactment.

National Civic League. "Creating Partnerships for Effective Youth Civic Learning." National Civic Review, 5 Aug. 2022, nationalcivicleague.org/ncr-article/creating-partnerships-for-effective-youth-civic-learning/.

This National Civic League article examines how school-community partnerships function as delivery mechanisms for youth civic learning, identifying the design features including authentic community connections, youth agency, and sustained relationships that distinguish effective from ineffective partnerships. It directly informed the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by establishing the partnership design principles the framework uses to evaluate and structure relationships between schools, community organizations, and local government entities.

National Youth Leadership Council. "The Hidden Costs of Poor Service-Learning Experiences: Why Quality Matters." 2025, nylc.org.

This NYLC article documents the documented harms of poorly implemented service-learning, including reinforcement of stereotypes, student disengagement, community organization burden, and lasting negative associations with civic participation when programs lack authentic community partnership and adequate student preparation. It contributed to the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by establishing the quality standards that distinguish transformative civic learning from tokenistic service delivery, informing the framework's partnership design criteria and implementation supports.

Network Delaware. "About Us." Network Delaware, thenetworkde.org/about.

Network Delaware is the civic organization through which this framework project was developed, serving as the organizational convener and community infrastructure for connecting schools, local government, and community organizations around civic

education in the state. Its "About Us" page contextualizes the framework within Network Delaware's broader mission of community building and civic engagement in Delaware, establishing the organizational credibility and stakeholder relationships that ground the project's community-rooted power building front.

Niemi, Richard G., and Jane Junn. *Civic Education: What Makes Students Learn*. Yale University Press, 1998.

Using data from the 1988 National Assessment of Educational Progress, Niemi and Junn argue empirically that secondary school civics courses do enhance students' civic knowledge and develop a theoretical model of how students learn about politics through instruction. Their finding that the content and recency of coursework, not just its presence determine civic knowledge gains provided the research foundation for the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front's emphasis on curriculum quality, instructional specificity, and standards rigor rather than mere course-completion mandates.

Nonviolent Schools RI. nonviolentschoolsri.org

Nonviolent Schools RI represents a regional school-based implementation model for integrating Kingian Nonviolence principles into K-12 educational environments, demonstrating how nonviolence education can be adapted for school communities across a state. It served as a practitioner reference for the Delaware framework's strategic nonviolence and leadership development front, providing a proximate geographic example of nonviolence education infrastructure that informed the design of Delaware's own school-based Kingian Nonviolence programming.

On Earth Peace. "Kingian Nonviolence Principles." onearthpeace.org/knv_principles.

This On Earth Peace resource articulates the Six Principles of Kingian Nonviolence and the Six Steps of Nonviolent Direct Action, which together constitute the philosophical and tactical framework derived from the civil rights movement legacy of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. It formed the core conceptual content of the Delaware framework's strategic nonviolence and leadership development front, providing the specific principles and steps around which workshop curricula, facilitator guides, and youth leadership development activities were organized.

Participatory Budgeting Project. "Participatory Budgeting in Schools: A Policy Scan." 2020, participatorybudgeting.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/03/PB-in-Schools-Policy-Scan-2020.pdf.

This Participatory Budgeting Project policy scan maps the conditions under which school and district policies enable student-led participatory budgeting, identifying enabling factors such as civic learning mandates, budget transparency requirements, and student

governance provisions, while cataloging obstacles like rigid budget cycles and limited decision-making authority. It informed the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by providing a replicable model of structured student financial decision-making that deepens civic agency, institutional literacy, and real-world problem-solving.

Poteat, V. Paul, et al. "Gay-Straight Alliance Involvement and Youths' Participation in Civic Engagement and Political Action." *Journal of Research on Adolescence*, vol. 28, no. 2, 2018, pp. 433-448, pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29805190/.

This study of 295 youth members across 33 Gay-Straight Alliances finds that greater GSA involvement is associated with higher rates of general civic engagement, LGBTQ-specific advocacy, and awareness-raising, with the association between GSA involvement and civic engagement partially mediated by youths' sense of agency. It contributed to the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building front by providing evidence that identity-affirming organizational participation generates transferable civic agency, supporting the rationale for inclusive, identity-conscious civic learning environments as drivers of broader democratic participation.

Sutter, Jessica, and Audra Watson. "The State of Youth Civic Engagement." *National Association of State Boards of Education (NASBE)*, vol. 25, no. 4, Sept. 2025, nasbe.org/the-state-of-youth-civic-engagement/.

This NASBE article by Institute for Citizens & Scholars researchers synthesizes data on youth civic participation, documents declining youth voter turnout from 50% in 2020 to 42% in 2024, and calls on state boards of education to expand structured civic learning opportunities beyond electoral cycles. It informed the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by establishing the urgency of sustained state-level action, providing the policy audience; state education boards, with specific recommendations that the Delaware framework operationalizes at the LEA and program level.

Thomas B. Fordham Institute. "The State of State Standards for Civics and U.S. History in 2021." Fordham Institute, 23 June 2021, fordhaminstitute.org/sites/default/files/publication/pdfs/20210623-state-state-standards-civics-and-us-history-20210.pdf.

This Fordham Institute report evaluates K-12 civics and U.S. History standards across all 50 states and the District of Columbia, rating them on content, rigor, organization, and clarity, and finding that only five jurisdictions earned exemplary ratings in both subjects while twenty states received inadequate ratings in both. It contributed to the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by situating Delaware's standards within the national landscape and identifying the specific quality dimensions

(content breadth, rigor, and organizational clarity) against which Delaware's framework should benchmark its standards reform.

Trevor Project, The. "Civic Engagement and Mental Health Among LGBTQ Young People." The Trevor Project, 6 Oct. 2025,
www.thetrevorproject.org/research-briefs/civic-engagement-and-mental-health-among-lgbtq-young-people/.

This Trevor Project research brief documents that 60% of LGBTQ+ young people reported motivation to take political action in the past year, with transgender and nonbinary youth showing higher rates, while also finding that LGBTQ+ political concerns are associated with greater anxiety and depression, suggesting that civic motivation and political vulnerability co-exist in this population. It contributed to the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building front by establishing the need for civic engagement structures that are explicitly affirming of LGBTQ+ youth identities and attentive to the mental health dimensions of political mobilization.

UCLA Center for Mental Health in Schools. "School-Community Partnerships: A Guide."
smhp.psych.ucla.edu/pdfdocs/partnership/scpartnerships.pdf.

This UCLA Center for Mental Health in Schools guide provides a comprehensive framework for building school-community partnerships, emphasizing collaborative multitiered systems of support, prevention orientation, and locally-empowered decision-making through asset-based approaches. It informed the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by supplying the partnership infrastructure model that connects schools, community health agencies, and civic organizations into coordinated civic learning ecosystems rather than siloed program delivery.

United Way of Delaware PRIDE Council. "LGBTQ Education, Health and Family Resources."
uwde.org/how-we-work/affinity-groups/pride-council/lgbtq-education-health-and-family-resources/.

The United Way of Delaware PRIDE Council's LGBTQ Education, Health and Family Resources guide links Delaware LGBTQ youth and their families to public and nonprofit agencies providing physical and behavioral health services, education support, and community resources statewide. It contributed to the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building front as a resource directory that maps the Delaware-specific support infrastructure needed to create genuinely inclusive civic engagement pathways for LGBTQ+ youth, whose civic participation is linked to both organizational access and identity-affirming environments.

WHYY News. "Delaware Falls Short on Funding for Multilingual Learners." WHYY, 2025, [whyy.org](https://www.whyy.org).

This WHYY investigative report documents Delaware's significant underfunding of multilingual learners relative to neighboring states, noting that Delaware provides approximately \$1,100 per multilingual learner compared to \$6,000–9,000 in New Jersey and Maryland, leaving the fastest-growing student population in the state without adequate resources. It contributed to the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by establishing the specific resource equity gap that must be addressed for multilingual learners to have equitable access to civic learning, given that underfunded students are disproportionately excluded from enrichment programming.

Winn, Maisha T. "Restorative Justice, Civic Education, and Transformative Possibilities." *Political and Legal Anthropology Review*, Sage Journals, 2023, doi.org/10.1177/00027162231188566.

Drawing on data from a Midwestern high school where students were trained in restorative justice theory and practice, Winn argues that restorative justice circle processes constitute a form of civic education by positioning youth as active community stakeholders, relational listeners, and agents of social change. It contributed to the Delaware framework's school-based partnerships and hands-on civic practice front by theorizing the intersection of restorative justice and civic education, establishing the conceptual basis for treating restorative circles as both a disciplinary and civic formation practice within K-12 settings.

Wray-Lake, Laura, et al. "Profiles of Civic Assets Among Youth of Color: Relations with Civic Action." *Journal of Youth and Adolescence*, ScienceDirect, Nov. 2022, [sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0193397322000880](https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0193397322000880).

This study uses latent profile analysis to identify distinct patterns of civic assets among youth of color, examining how configurations of social responsibility values, civic knowledge, civic skills, and organizational involvement predict civic action. It contributed to the Delaware framework's community-rooted power building front by providing an empirical framework for understanding how civic development unfolds differentially across youth of color, informing the design of equity-centered civic programming that cultivates multiple forms of civic capacity simultaneously rather than privileging narrowly defined electoral participation.

YIP Institute. "When Civic Education Fails, Democracy Follows." YIP Institute, 18 Jan. 2026, yipinstitute.org/article/when-civic-education-fails-democracy-follows.

This YIP Institute article argues that inadequate civic education is a structural cause of political disengagement, documenting that students with high civic proficiency are more than twice as likely to understand why political participation matters and that racial and

socioeconomic disparities in civic education directly mirror disparities in voter turnout. It supported the Delaware framework's statewide policy and LEA implementation front by establishing the democratic stakes of the framework's work, that without consistent, high-quality civics instruction, civic inequality becomes entrenched across race, gender, and class lines.